

Bronco Test vs. Yo-Yo Test: How to Train for BCCI's Tougher Fitness Standard

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If you learned your cricket fitness benchmarks from the Yo-Yo test era, there's a new name you need to know: the **Bronco test**. Team India's fitness coach Adrian Le Roux introduced it ahead of the 2025 Asia Cup, and it's now the fitness standard players are measured against — including, indirectly, everyone coming up through state and age-group cricket hoping to get noticed. AB de Villiers, who's seen every fitness fad cricket has thrown at players, described the experience bluntly: "those lungs would burn."

What actually changed

The **Yo-Yo test** is the one most Indian cricket fans already know — a 20m shuttle run, paced by beeps that get progressively faster, with a short recovery jog built into every rep. It measures repeated high-intensity running with recovery — a proxy for aerobic capacity under intermittent load. The benchmark most players were held to was around level 16.1, with talk of raising it toward 17.

The **Bronco test** is a different animal entirely, borrowed from rugby conditioning. Four cones are set at 0m, 20m, 40m, and 60m. One rep means sprinting to the 20m cone and back, then the 40m cone and back, then the 60m cone and back — 240 metres per rep. Players complete **five reps back-to-back with zero rest**, totaling 1,200 metres, and need to finish in around **six minutes** to qualify.

Why swap tests at all

The Yo-Yo test's built-in recovery periods reward short bursts of speed with a breather in between — useful, but not quite how a match actually feels. The Bronco test removes that safety net entirely. There's no recovery jog to hide in; you're running continuously under accumulating fatigue for the full six minutes, which is a much closer match to the reality of quick running between wickets over a long innings, or covering ground in the field for hours without a real break. Reports around the change also pointed to a specific concern: some bowlers were spending more time in the gym than actually running, and the Bronco test was partly a corrective — you can't lift your way past it.

How to actually train for it

1. Build the aerobic base before you attack the test itself. The Bronco test punishes players who only train in short sprint bursts. Three to four sessions a week of steady-state running (20–40 minutes, conversational pace) builds the underlying engine that makes the sprint-repeat pattern survivable.

2. Learn to pace it, don't just sprint and hope. Divide your target time by 5 to get your per-rep pace — a 6-minute Bronco means roughly 72 seconds per rep. Start at or slightly below your previous best pace for the first few reps, and save any extra push for the final rep. Athletes who go out too fast in rep one predictably blow up by rep four.

3. Drill the turns, not just the sprints. Six cone turns per rep, thirty across the full test — each one costs time if it's sloppy. Practicing sharp, low, economical 180-degree turns is a cheap way to shave real seconds off your total without any extra fitness gain at all.

4. Train it fatigued, not just fresh. Since match running happens on tired legs, not fresh ones, the most useful place to practice Bronco-style efforts is at the end of a skills or fielding session — not as the first thing you do when you're fully recovered.

Why this matters beyond the national team

You don't need to be chasing a Team India spot for this to be relevant. The Hyderabad Cricket Association has already stepped up its own **Fitness Assessment & Camp for the 2026–27 season**, covering Senior, Under-23, and Under-19 players ahead of the Ranji Trophy, Vijay Hazare Trophy, and Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy squads. Fitness standards trickle down fast in Indian cricket — what the national team is tested on today tends to show up in state trials within a season or two.

Building genuine running capacity, not just gym strength, is exactly the kind of conditioning work our programs at Kanhustle Fitness build into every training block. If you or your child are eyeing HCA trials this season, let's structure training around the standard you'll actually be tested on.

Sources

- [Why Team India's fitness coach Adrian Le Roux introduced the Bronco Test ahead of Asia Cup 2025 — Gulf News](#)
- [What Is Bronco Test in Cricket: How It Works, Rules, and Why It's Different from the Yo-Yo Test — IPL.com](#)
- ["Those lungs would burn" — AB de Villiers reveals his experience of BCCI's new Bronco test — Sportskeeda](#)
- [Bronco Test takes centrestage as BCCI redefines fitness standards — The Statesman](#)
- [Hyderabad Cricket Association — Press Archive \(2026–27 Fitness Assessment & Camp\)](#)